regularly is no easy task. If our international profile has become sharper in the last decade, this is the outcome of a series of policies, decisions and activities. Visions and even goals need strategizing to be realized on the ground. This means interactions, investments and messaging in a focussed and sustained manner. What the public sees is an elegant swan; underneath, there is furious paddling.

The most noticeable feature of PM Modi's work style is the ability to constantly integrate the big picture and the smallest of details. He could be as immersed in briefings about chip wars or energy futures as in handling of evacuation operations or in the value of a best practice. Every visit, every speech and every engagement has a meaning; they end up as one part of a larger mosaic. Some of what is debated and decided responds to the demand of events. But the more persistent thread is of determinedly charting a strategic course and adjusting that to the unpredictability of our times. It would probably surprise many to learn how much time and effort has gone into that larger exercise over the last decade. The unfolding may look natural and often spontaneous, but the reality is actually one of continuous planning and implementation.

The 'what' and the 'how' of Modi's foreign policy is there for all to see. The 'why' is a more complex proposition, one that is perhaps sensed intuitively by the public. Much of it flows from a strongly ingrained belief in India's capability to contribute to a better world. It resides in a self-perception of a well-wisher to the world, for whom the international community is a family, clearly a more confident posture than in the past. But that itself is only a facet of a deeper commitment to national rejuvenation and the resurgence of a civilization. At home, they obviously take the form of building capabilities, undertaking reform and enhancing the quality of governance. Abroad, this is expressed in terms of a greater ability to influence the global agenda. This outlook is able to meld progressive thinking and embrace of technology comfortably with the traditions and authenticity of India. And it sees no contradiction in espousing internationalism abroad while articulating nationalism at home. This is an India determined to play on the big stage, even change the stage itself where necessary to advance its interests. Its motivational power at home is paralleled by a desire to promote understanding beyond its borders.

This book is a collection of 11 essays, all of them interconnected and some even overlapping. They range from an analysis of the global